

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST · NATIONAL ROAD SAFETY BOARD

Crashfree India

Application to Working Group 2: Safe Roads, Speeds & Vulnerable Road Users

A technology-led road safety nonprofit — backed by Cars24, operated by the Vision Zero Trust — working with public authorities across 18 cities.

31

sites audited across 18 cities

7

fixes fully implemented

25+

written authority approvals



MS DHONI · GOODWILL AMBASSADOR,
CRASHFREE INDIA

A letter to the Working Group



New Delhi · August 2026

Respected Chairperson and Members of Working Group 2,

Crashfree India is a young road safety nonprofit — registered as the Vision Zero Trust, co-founded with the Indian Road Safety Council, and backed by a three-year, US\$3 million commitment from Cars24. We work alongside public authorities: our student teams audit dangerous locations under senior experts, our technology helps police and administrators see their own pipelines, and our support tools stand with families after a crash. MS Dhoni carries this message to the country as our Goodwill Ambassador.

In our first year we audited 31 high-risk locations across 18 cities, secured 25+ written approvals from road-owning authorities, and saw 7 sites fully implemented with 6 more partially built — each tracked on a public dashboard. SATARK, our AI enforcement platform, has screened over 3,00,000 vehicles for police in Jaipur and Bengaluru and has now reached Gurugram. Four open-data platforms, the Aasha victim chatbot and hospital helpdesks complete the picture.

The pages that follow introduce the organisation briefly, then set out the work most relevant to this Working Group in the detail its mandate deserves. Everything shown is running today, is public, and is offered to the Board without cost. We would be honoured to contribute.

Respectfully,

Akhtar Hussain

Mission Lead, Crashfree India · akhtar@crashfreeindia.org · crashfreeindia.org

Five sections, **three minutes** to skim

1



About us — and how we work

Who we are, our approach to the road crash crisis, and why this Working Group.

04 – 06

2



What we have built

Every public-facing programme — audits, enforcement tech, victim support, open data, youth, campaigns.

07 – 14

3



Our people

The team, its capabilities, and the expert bench around the work.

15 – 16

4



Project Rakshak in depth

The deep dive matched to this Working Group's mandate — evidence, method, results.

17 – 25

5



How we can contribute

Four concrete, no-cost offers to the Working Group.

26 – 27

Crashfree India: a nonprofit that adds **capacity** to road safety work

Registered as the Vision Zero Trust · Co-founded by Cars24 and the Indian Road Safety Council · Working since June 2025 · New Delhi



Evidence first

Structured field audits, file reviews and research to official standards — not opinion.



Institutional collaboration

We work through PWDs, NHAI, transport departments, police and District Road Safety Committees.



Youth-led capacity

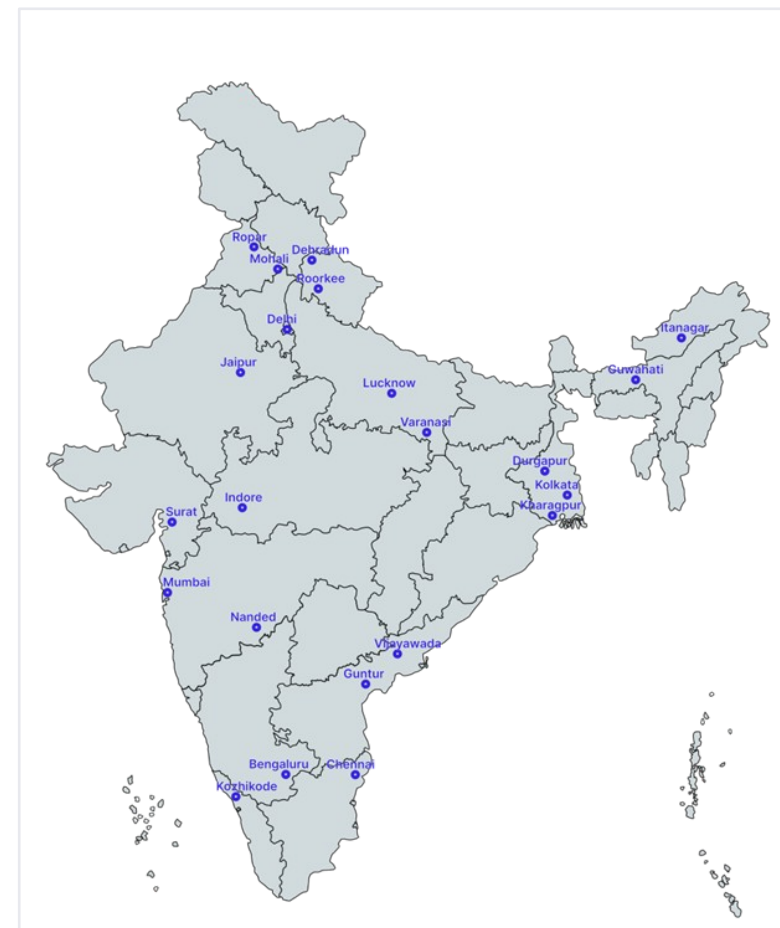
Trained student teams from IITs, NITs and SPAs add the auditing hands the system needs.



Technology for follow-through

Public dashboards track every recommendation from submission to completion.

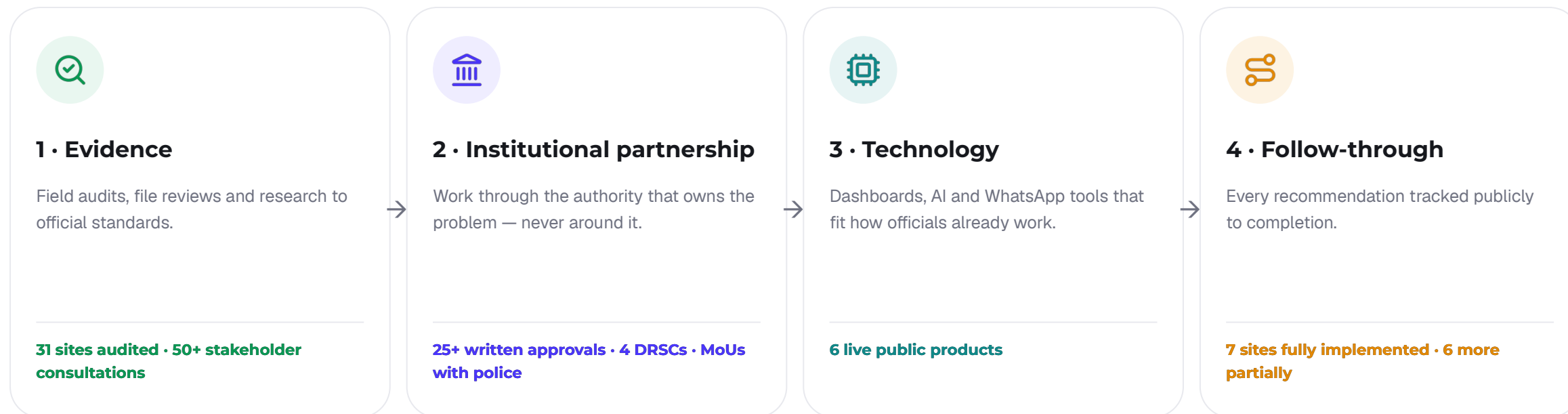
Backed by a US\$3 million, three-year commitment from Cars24 — programmes, not overheads, receive 71% of the budget.



Where we work today — 18 cities, north to south.

Our approach: work **with the system**, and prove it with data

Four steps, applied to every problem we take up — from a dangerous junction to a stalled compensation claim.



We do not replace the system and we do not campaign against it. We add hands, evidence and tools to work the system has already committed to.

Why Working Group 2 — and what we bring to it

The Group's mandate matches the deepest part of our portfolio. Three focus areas where we are ready on day one.



Black-spot rectification at scale

Our audit-to-implementation pipeline is running in 18 cities — the Group's rectification agenda is our core work.



Standards for audits & speed management

IRC-anchored audit instruments, masterclass-trained teams, and a direct line into IRC H-7 via our advisor.



Protecting vulnerable road users

Pedestrian-first audits, the 300-rider gig-safety study, school-zone screening — evidence ready for VRU standards.

EXISTING CAPABILITIES WE PUT ON THE TABLE

31 trained audit teams

Public tracking portal

District pilots: GGM · SWD · Jaipur

IRC H-7 advisory line

7 sites fully built

Expert bench on call

SUBJECT-MATTER EXPERTS ALREADY ENGAGED ON THIS AGENDA



Prof. Geetam Tiwari

TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi · IRC H-7



Abhay Damle

Ex-Joint Secretary, MoRTH



Vaibhav Dange

Ex-Advisor, MoRTH



Akhilesh Srivastava

ITS India · IRF

Six lines of work, one connected system

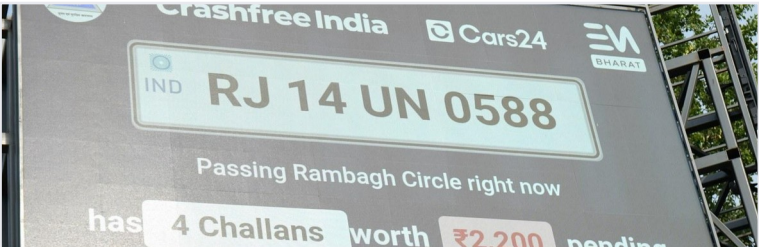
Audits create data · data supports policy · policy guides the field. Everything below is live today.



Project Rakshak

Student-led road audits, fixed with authorities

31 sites · 7 fixes fully built



SATARK enforcement

AI support that helps police find high-risk vehicles

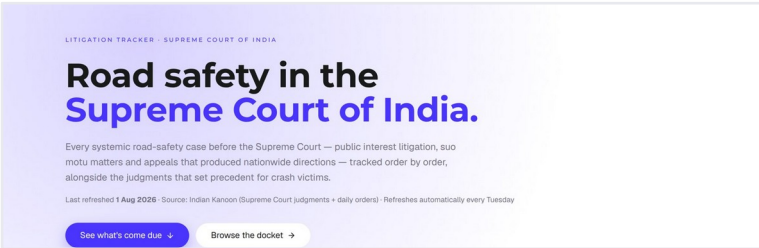
3,00,000+ vehicles screened



Victim support

Aasha chatbot, calculator, hospital helpdesks

100+ victims helped in first 4 days



Open public data

Four self-updating data platforms, free to use

36 states & 50 cities covered



Youth & policy

NextMile ideathon and national dialogue series

2,000+ participants engaged



Public campaigns

Road Safety Month with police & schools; MS Dhoni

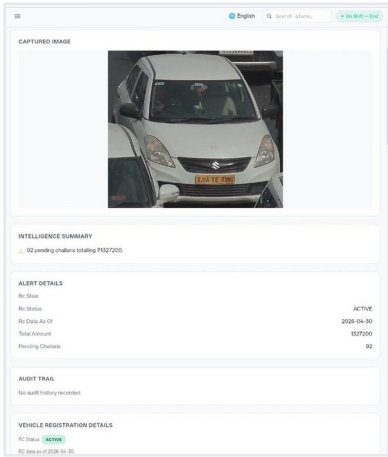
1M+ citizens reached

SATARK: AI that helps police stop the right vehicle

Built with Cars24 engineers. Reads number plates, checks government records, and alerts officers to repeat offenders — in real time.



Rambagh Circle, Jaipur — live plate, pending challans and dues on a public billboard.



Officer view — challans, RC & compliance status.

3,00,000+

vehicles screened

₹30 Cr+

pending challan value identified

350+

high-risk vehicles intercepted

70,019

vehicles found with pending challans

LIVE · Jaipur & Bengaluru

NEW · Gurugram

Bengaluru's Trinity Circle billboard was India's first — covered by Deccan Herald and national press. Pune and Ahmedabad are next.



Four live data platforms — free for any authority

Each one turns a scattered public record into structured, citable evidence. Self-updating; no login, no fee.

Over the last month, we have built and shipped four products, each one turning a scattered public record — news reports, parliamentary questions, court orders, MoRTH's annual books — into structured, citable evidence. All four run themselves in the cloud on autopilot; nothing depends on anyone's laptop.

INFRASTRUCTURE · DAILY

National Road-Infrastructure Defect Repository

[cfi-defect-repository.vercel.app](#)

An AI pipeline reads local-language news from **146 districts across Bihar, UP and Rajasthan** every morning, extracts road-defect incidents — potholes, missing signage, unlit stretches, blind curves — geocodes them, and clusters repeat locations into ranked hotspots on a public map. Every published entry passes a confidence gate plus review on our

PARLIAMENT · DAILY IN SESSION

Road Safety in Parliament

[road-safety-parliament.vercel.app](#)

Every road-safety question asked in Parliament since 2014 — **1,423 questions across four ministries** — with a find-your-MP lookup, state rollups, shareable MP report cards, and a live strip for the ongoing Monsoon Session. **282 sitting Lok Sabha MPs have never asked one.** RTI Watch (at /rti) pairs it with our own Delhi MACT RTI campaign — the questions we ask from below.

COURTS · WEEKLY

Supreme Court Litigation Tracker

[deepanshucfi.github.io/sc-litigation-tracker](#)

Order-by-order timelines of the Supreme Court's systemic road-safety cases — Rajaseekaran, the Phalodi suo motu, SaveLIFE's PM RAHAT matter and more: **18 tracked cases, 190+ orders, 27 precedent judgments.** Its Accountability Ledger logs every concrete direction the Court gives MoRTH, NHAI and states, with deadlines that flip to overdue automatically as dates pass.

18 tracked cases, 190+ orders

11 court directions overdue at

CRASH DATA · ANNUAL

Crash Data Dashboard

[cfi-crash-dashboard.vercel.app](#)

MoRTH's annual *Road Accidents in India* books (2019–2024, each a 266-page PDF) turned into a public product: **1,77,175 people killed in 2024 — 485 every day** — told through a story-first opening, report cards for 36 states and 50 cities, 21 verified analytical findings, and a compensation rights hub for victims' families. Every number is reconciled against the printed books; all data is open for download (CC-BY).

485 people killed per day (RAI)

36+50 state and city report cards

LITIGATION TRACKER · SUPREME COURT OF INDIA

Road safety in the Supreme Court of India.

Every systemic road-safety case before the Supreme Court — public interest litigation, suo motu matters and appeals that produced nationwide directions — tracked order by order, alongside the judgments that set precedent for crash victims.

Last refreshed **1 Aug 2026** · Source: Indian Kanoon (Supreme Court judgments + daily orders) · Refreshes automatically every Tuesday

See what's come due ↴

Browse the docket →

20

systemic cases tracked

6

pending before the Court

1

under compliance monitoring

13

disposed with directions

191

orders indexed

30

precedent judgments

Live view, 1 Aug 2026 — 20 systemic cases · 191 orders indexed · 30 precedent judgments. Refreshes every Tuesday.

सुरक्षा मित्र
Suraksha Mitra

सड़क बुनियादी ढांचा, व्यवहार और ट्रैफिक उत्पन्न रिपोर्टिंग

सड़क खतरों, ट्रैफिक उत्पन्न (सिग्नल जोड़ना, गलत पार्किंग, बिना हेलमेट), खतरनाक चौराहों और असुरक्षित ड्राइविंग की रिपोर्ट करें

क्या रिपोर्ट किया जा सकता है ↴

सड़क सुरक्षा सुचक
Sadak Suraksha Suchak

सार्वजनिक परिवहन और वाहन सुरक्षा रिपोर्टिंग

बस सुरक्षा मुद्दों की रिपोर्ट करें जिसमें अवरुद्ध निकास, खराब उपकरण, अत्यधिक भीड़, लापरवाह ड्राइविंग और सुरक्षा मानकों का पालन न करना शामिल है

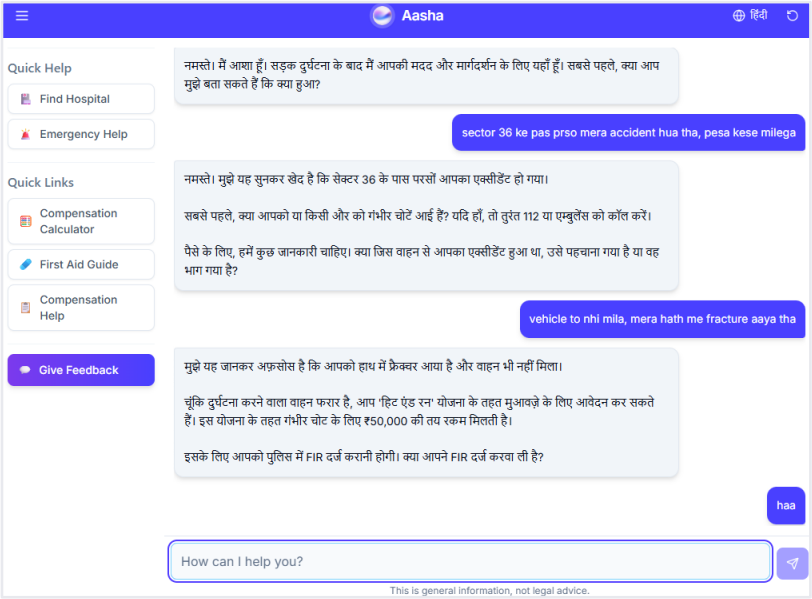
क्या रिपोर्ट किया जा सकता है ↴

Plus: Suraksha Mitra & Sadak Suraksha Suchak — citizen hazard reporting in Hindi (50+ hazards in the first 20 days).

Product cards from our internal data-stack brief, July 2026 — descriptions as shipped.

Help a family can actually use, in their language

From the first hours after a crash to the final compensation order — on WhatsApp, on paper, and in person.



Aasha, live on WhatsApp — 24/7, multilingual, step-by-step guidance on rights, schemes and documents.

Aasha chatbot — India's first AI legal companion for crash victims — no app, no portal, just WhatsApp and voice.

Hospital helpdesks — Legal desks in trauma wards — 100+ victims supported in the first four days.

The Calculator — a sample estimate computed on SC principles.

Compensation Calculator — Free instant estimates on Supreme Court principles (Sarla Verma, Pranay Sethi).

Plain-language education — Comics and Hindi guides on all three compensation routes, NALSA 15100 and the Cashless Treatment Scheme 2025.



'Meet Aasha' comic — legal education families actually read.

Young talent and senior experts, working the same problem

A steady pipeline of engineers and policy minds — so road safety work never runs out of hands.



NextMile: Road Safety Policy Ideathon — grand finale, 28 Sep 2025, New Delhi.

2,000+

250+

700+

10

participants

concept notes

teams

finalist teams



Vision Wall 2040 — participants write the road-safety future they want.

Mentors and evaluators came from the Government of Rajasthan, NIUA, OMI, NASSCOM and CSEP. Winning tracks now feed our audit and research pipeline.

**National Road Safety Dialogue Series**

200+ live attendees; speakers from MoRTH, CIRT, AIIMS Trauma Centre, CSIR-CRRI and ARAI.

**Three sessions so far**

Bus safety · Delivery rider safety · Good Samaritan law & the Cashless Treatment Scheme.

**Public YouTube channel**

Session recordings, victim-education videos and explainers — free to reuse in trainings.

Next: 'Be a Rakshak' university chapters at IITs, NITs and SPAs.

Road Safety Month 2026, run **with the system**

With district police, schools, hospitals and delivery platforms — in Hindi and local languages.



National Road Safety Month rally — on the road with district traffic police, Jan 2026.

1M+ citizens reached across campaigns in year one.



CFI stall at a government office



Materials briefing with police staff



School programme with certificates



Delivery-rider outreach — Swiggy & Instamart

MS Dhoni carries the message; the press covers the work



MS Dhoni — Goodwill Ambassador, announced April 2026.

Dhoni's voice powers 'Be a Rakshak', school-zone safety and compensation-awareness campaigns.

"We already know what is going wrong. What we need now is more responsibility, more discipline, more respect for life."

MS Dhoni, at the National Road Safety Implementation Forum, IIT Delhi

IN THE NATIONAL PRESS

Hindustan Times

India's Road Safety Primer Flags Gaps in Pre-Hospital Emergency Care

Crashfree India's new primer highlights systemic delays in trauma response, calls for benchmarks, trauma registries, and citizen training.

Updated on: Oct 01, 2025 3:35 PM IST
By Genesis

A group of people, including MS Dhoni, standing on a stage and holding blue certificates that read 'NextMile: Road Safety Policy Ideathon'.

Hindustan Times — on our Pre-Hospital Care Primer.

CrashFree India Ideathon pitches bold road safety solutions, focus on delivery riders and compensation

Ten finalist teams from across the country pitched ideas, guided by mentors, including IIT professors, legal experts and practitioners, at the India Habitat Centre.

TIMESOFINDIA.COM
Published On Sep 23, 2025 at 11:57 AM IST

A close-up of a motorcyclist wearing a black helmet and a blue jacket, looking forward.

ThePrint — on the NextMile ideathon finale.

Bloomberg

Deccan Herald Economic Times Fortune India

IndiaSpend Scroll.in The Wire

Times of India Business Standard

The institutions around the work

As they appear in our working decks — engagement ranges from formal MoUs and written approvals to jury, mentoring and research collaboration.

AUTHORITIES & PUBLIC BODIES WE WORK WITH



UNIVERSITIES & INSTITUTES FIELDING AUDIT TEAMS



EXPERT & ECOSYSTEM PARTNERS



Plus: Jaipur Traffic Police & Gurugram Police (MoUs) · CPWD & district administrations · Bloomberg, Johns Hopkins, Centre for Green Mobility and PwC experts on juries and reviews.

A full-time team built for this work

Engineering, law, policy, product and field operations — under trustees who have led Indian road safety for a decade.

AS

Amar Srivastava
President · Founder, Indian Road Safety Campaign ·
Member, National Road Safety Council

DG

Deepanshu Gupta
Managing Trustee · Founder, IRSC · Global Youth
Coalition for Road Safety

GJ

Gajendra Jangid
General Secretary · Co-founder, Cars24

THE FULL-TIME TEAM

AH

Akhtar Hussain
Mission Lead
IIT Delhi

SK

Shubham Kumar
Policy & Advocacy
NALSAR Hyderabad

MY

Muskan Yadav
Programmes
TISS

AS

Aastha Shreeharsh
Strategy & Ops
HKUST

RS

Rohan Sharma
Cause Marketing

IR

Ishita Rathore
People & Culture

YY

Yuvraj Yadav
Product Design

SK

Shipra Kushwaha
Graphic Design

In-house capabilities: road-engineering audits · legal & policy research · AI product development · district operations · behaviour-change communication. **Plus 75+ engineering interns and 31 student audit teams.**

Advised by the people who built India's road safety practice



Prof. Geetam Tiwari — Board of Advisors

Professor Emerita & Chair, TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi · Member, IRC H-7 Committee on Road Safety Audit



Piyush Tewari — Board of Advisors

Founder & CEO, SaveLIFE Foundation · Architect of the Good Samaritan Law · Zero-Fatality Corridors

JURY, MENTORS & REVIEWERS AROUND OUR WORK



Justice J.R. Midha
Delhi High Court (Retd.)



Abhay Damle
Ex-JS, MoRTH



Vaibhav Dange
Ex-Advisor, MoRTH



Dr. Maya Tandon
Sahayta Trust



R. Venkat Ratnam
Government of Punjab



Akhilesh Srivastava
ITS India · IRF



Gautam Singh
SaveLIFE Foundation



Aishwarya Raman
OMI Foundation



Neeraj Kumar
Tata AIG



R.S. Pandey
FICCI Road Safety



Dipak K. Dash
Times of India

Engaged through the National Road Safety Dialogue Series: Balraj Bhanot (ex-Chair, CMVR-TSC) · I.V. Rao (TERI; ex-Maruti Suzuki) · D.P. Saste (CIRT / ex-MoRTH) · Dr. Sushma Sagar (AIIMS Trauma) · Dr. S. Velmurugan (CSIR-CRRI) — and jurors from OMI, NIUA, WRI, CII and Tata AIG.

Project Rakshak, in one sentence

Trained student teams, guided by senior road-safety experts, audit dangerous road locations — and Crashfree India walks each recommended fix through the road-owning authority until it is built.



Students audit

Teams from IITs, NITs and SPAs collect data on-site: traffic, conflicts, 900+ stakeholder surveys.



Experts verify

Mentors anchor every audit to IRC codes and MoRTH checklists before anything is proposed.



Authorities build

The fix goes to the PWD, corporation or NHAI in its own format — and we track it to completion.

Four phases each cohort: Research & problem identification → Stakeholder engagement & audits → Analysis & costed solutions → Reporting & authority engagement

Identification has outpaced rectification — **capacity is the constraint**

The knowledge exists; the pipeline that turns identified risk into completed engineering needs more trained hands.

13,795

black spots identified nationally (MoRTH)

5,036

permanently rectified so far (Parliamentary Standing Committee, 2024)

44

certified Road Safety Auditors on the national registry (July 2026)

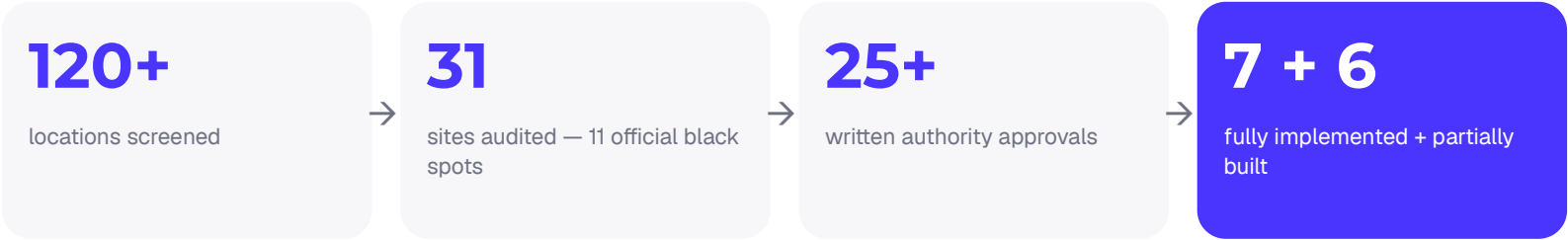
Low-cost engineering measures — raised crossings, traffic calming, lighting, safer intersections — reduce crashes by 20–80% where applied (iRAP & PIARC evidence). What limits progress is steady, supervised auditing capacity and follow-up, working under the road-owning authority.

Project Rakshak was designed for precisely this constraint: trained auditing capacity that supports road-owning agencies — and tracks every fix to completion.



Guntur, Andhra Pradesh — drainage correction underway after audit.

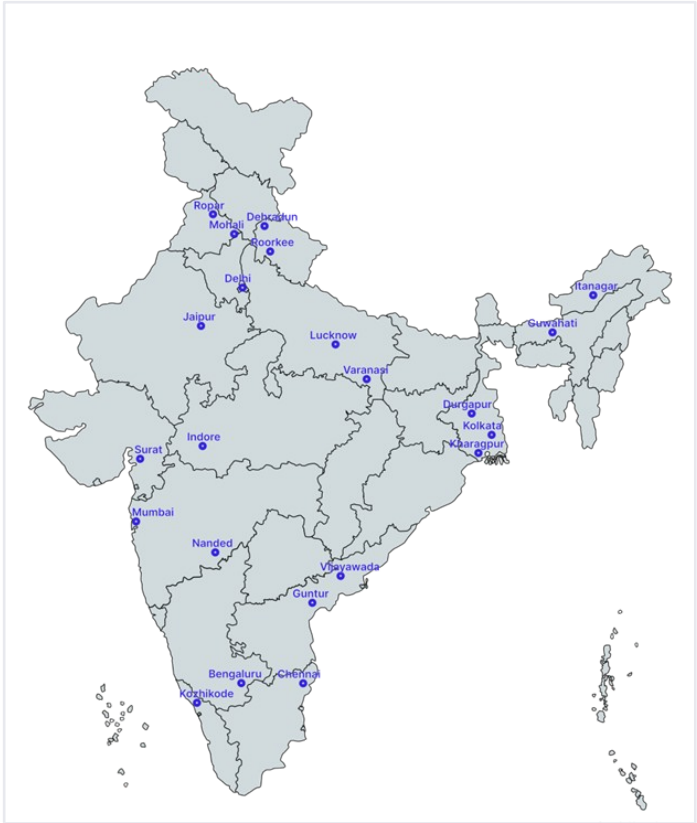
Cohort 1: a national footprint, now delivering



31 student teams · 20 institutions including nine IITs · 900+ stakeholder surveys · guided by 8 mentors and independent evaluators

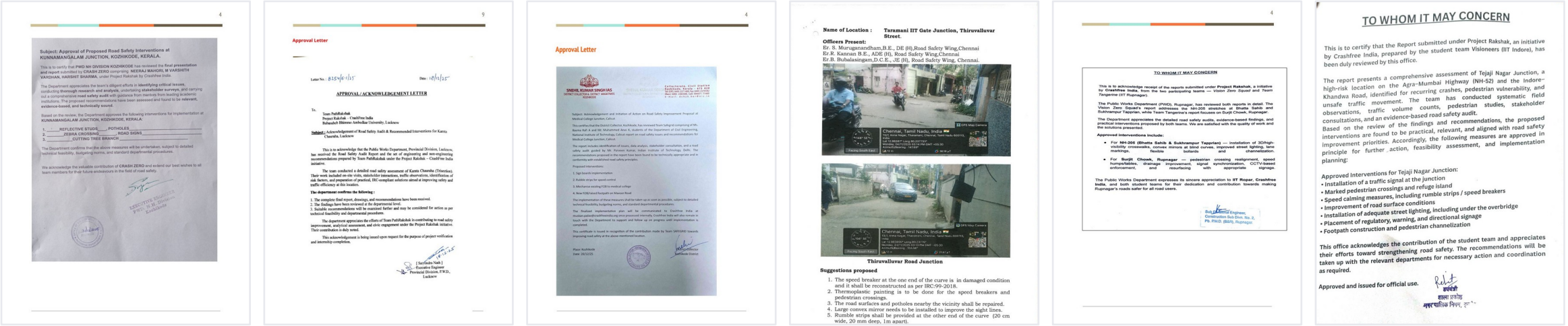
North: Ropar, Dehradun, Roorkee, Delhi, Lucknow, Varanasi · East: Guwahati, Durgapur · West & Central: Indore, Mumbai, Surat · South: Vijayawada, Guntur, Kozhikode, Chennai — among 18 cities.

Estimated 20–50% crash reduction at treated sites once complete — based on WHO / iRAP evidence for these counter-measures; we will verify with before-and-after data as implementations finish.



Cohort-1 sites across India.

Approvals in writing, from the authorities that own the roads



A sample of the 25+ approval and acknowledgement letters issued by public works and district authorities.

APPROVING AUTHORITIES INCLUDE

PWD Kerala

PWD Uttar Pradesh

PWD Punjab

CPWD + Addl. Collector, Indore

ADDA Durgapur

R&B Andhra Pradesh

GCC Chennai

BMC Mumbai


PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT (PWD)




DISTRICT LOCAL
MUNICIPALITY AUTHORITY



From approval to construction — and to completion

Live status from our public implementation tracker, August 2026.



Parking rationalisation — Durgapur



Fresh markings — Guntur



Footpath construction — Indore



Signage — Mumbai

7 sites fully implemented

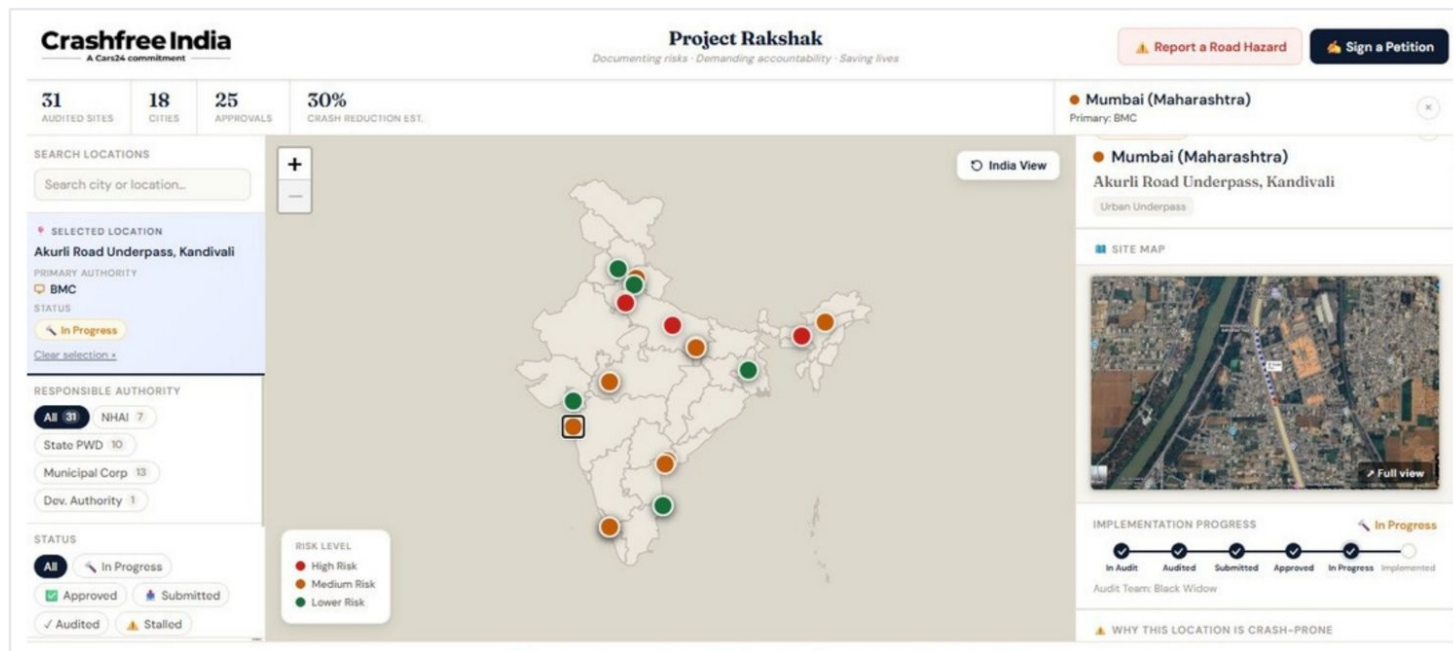
Outer Ring Road (Delhi) · IIT Madras Taramani Gate (Chennai) · Dafi Toll Plaza (Varanasi) · Akurli Road Underpass (Mumbai) · C-49 Commercial Area (Durgapur) · Chuttugunta Circle (Guntur) · Rau Gol Square (Indore)

6 more partially implemented — Kunnamangalam & Chevayur (Kozhikode), TIDEL Park (Chennai), Shivpur (Varanasi), Tejaji Nagar (Indore), Civil Lines (Roorkee); action initiated at further sites.

MARQUEE CASE — OUTER RING ROAD, SOUTH DELHI

On our audit, PWD built a continuous 1.8 m accessible pedestrian corridor, upgraded drainage at ponding sites, installed bollards against footpath encroachment, and deployed camera-backed speed-feedback boards.

A public dashboard tracks every site to completion



Live public dashboard — every site, its authority, risk level and implementation stage.



Every site tracked

From submission through approval to completed construction — regardless of who audited it.



The PRAGATI parallel

The PM's PRAGATI platform showed what visible follow-up does for stuck projects. Same principle here, for road safety fixes.



What the Board gains

An honest, live read on how quickly road-owning agencies can act — evidence for capacity planning, not just compliance.

Anchored to the codes **your engineers already use**



IRC codes & MoRTH checklists

Every audit instrument is built on them — nothing bespoke, nothing incompatible.



A line into IRC H-7

Prof. Geetam Tiwari, member of the IRC H-7 Committee on Road Safety Audit, chairs our advisory work.



Masterclasses before fieldwork

Prof. Tiwari on the Safe System approach; Dr. S. Velmurugan (CSIR-CRRI) on IRC-131 and SP-55.



Handover in the authority's format

Findings arrive as the PWD or corporation needs them — ready to action, tracked publicly after.



Authority engagement is continuous — audit teams present to the engineers who own the road.



Built to be institutionalised — not to depend on us

Three audit tracks matched to road types, and a role for CFI that narrows over time.

Track A — Institutional	Track B — NGO partners	Track C — Certified RSAs
IIT / NIT / SPA teams under expert mentors	Field teams; desk-reviewed and re-verified by CFI	CSIR-CRRI-certified auditors, full IRC SP-88
Urban arterials, in-town state highways, district roads	District & peri-urban corridors	National highways, complex junctions

Today	CFI runs cohorts, quality-controls audits and stewards the public portal.
Next	Rakshak Audit Manual v1.0 codifies the method; universities field their own teams; NGOs run Track B directly.
Mature	States engage certified RSAs for Track C without CFI as intermediary; the portal remains the shared public record.

A growing evidence base on those most at risk

Roughly 70% of India's road crash fatalities are vulnerable road users — pedestrians, motorcyclists, bicyclists.



Gig & delivery riders

'When Risks Become Routine' (Feb 2026): incentive pressure, helmet compliance and training gaps — 300+ rider study, Delhi NCR.



Pedestrian-first audits

Rakshak audits document crossings, footpaths and lighting as designable protections — 900+ stakeholders consulted.



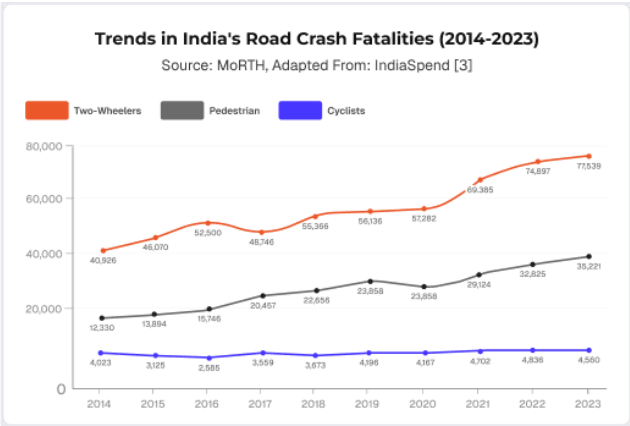
School zones

College-led, standards-based school-zone screening under exploration as the next extension of the audit platform.



Enforcement that protects VRUs

SATARK helps police prioritise the small share of vehicles with the worst records — targeted, fair, technology-led.



Fatality trends by road-user type, 2014–2023 (MoRTH; via IndiaSpend).



Four concrete offers to Working Group 2

All four are ready today, need no funding from the Board, and can begin within weeks.

- 1

Ready evidence for standard-setting

Site-level audit data, crash-pattern analysis and costed intervention designs across emerging hotspots and official black spots — for rectification protocols and speed-management guidance.
- 2

A live testing ground

Active district relationships in Gurugram, South-West Delhi and Jaipur offer a ready pipeline to pilot or stress-test draft recommendations before national rollout.
- 3

Ground-level implementation diagnostics

Granular, field-verified insight into how DRSCs and road-owning agencies actually move — meeting cadence, data use, follow-through.
- 4

Technical bench strength on request

Our academic and expert network stands ready for drafting, review and technical input on road design, speed and VRU standards.

We would be honoured to contribute to Working Group 2.

Our evidence, our district relationships, our technology and our expert bench are available to the Board — in whichever way is most useful.

"We already know what is going wrong. What we need now is more responsibility, more discipline, more respect for life."

MS Dhoni · Goodwill Ambassador, Crashfree India

 crashfreeindia.org

 akhtar@crashfreeindia.org · helpdesk@crashfreeindia.org

